SECTION B: VOCABULARY AND GRAMMAR (40 points) PART 1.

For questions 1-16, choose the letter A, B, C, or D to indicate the word / phrase which best completes each sentence. Write your answers in the numbered spaces provided.

1. If the Moon _____ one orbit around the Earth and one complete revolution on its axis at the same rate, we _____ the other side of it.

A. won't complete / will see **B.** didn't complete / would see
C. doesn't complete / had seen **D.** wouldn't complete / see

2. The company's decision _____ by an independent engineer proved to be a wise investment in the long run.

A. of having the old machinery inspect **B.** to have the old machinery inspected
C. to get the old machinery to inspect **D.** of getting the old machinery be inspected

3. The government has announced plans to _____ petrol-powered vehicles in an effort to encourage the use of cleaner energy sources.

A. phase out **B.** take off **C.** scale up **D.** cut down

4. _____ hundreds of people dead during the evacuation from the war-torn area.

A. It is estimated to be **B.** There is estimated to be
C. There are estimated to be **D.** It is estimated that

5. _____, the unwavering patriotism of the Vietnamese people now shines as a permanent beacon of love for our homeland.

A. Rooted in the historic milestone of national independence
B. To root in the historic milestone of national independence
C. Rooting in the historic milestone of national independence
D. Having rooted in the historic milestone of national independence

6. Despite the new management team's efforts to streamline the company, the productivity levels in the two departments remain _____ different.

A. perfectly **B.** vastly **C.** deeply **D.** bitterly

7. Linda and Katie were badly injured in the last match, so _____ of them can play in this one.

A. neither **B.** none **C.** either **D.** both

8. Tom's employment _____ would be better if he had a clean driving licence.

A. opportunities **B.** odds **C.** prospects **D.** likelihood

9. The sudden expansion of heated air associated with lightning produces _____ often heard during a storm.

A. thunder, is the rumbling sound **B.** the rumbling sound, thunder is
C. the rumbling sound, thunder, that **D.** thunder, the rumbling sound

10. The new manager may be _____ but he seems to end up annoying a lot of people.

A. well-meaning **B.** well-appointed **C.** well-born **D.** well-built

11. My aunt is really intolerant _____ anyone who has a different point of view to her own.

A. on **B.** at **C.** with **D.** of

12. _____ that we had to ask a police officer for directions.

A. So confusing was the map **B.** Such was the map confusing
C. So confusing the map was **D.** Such confusing was the map

13. I think people who help the old, poor, sick and homeless are _____.

A. the sugar of the land **B.** the salt of the earth
C. the salt of the ocean **D.** the sugar of the sea

14. _____ should humanity allow artificial intelligence to determine the artistic value of human emotion, for that is the final frontier of our unique consciousness.

A. Under no circumstances **B.** In any case
C. By all means **D.** Of no conditions

36.	The company is owned by Ford, the _____ corporation whose branches can be found in different continents.	**NATION**
37.	Vietnamese _____ have recently proposed a new healthcare reform bill aiming at reducing treatment costs for citizens.	**LAW**
38.	Setting foot on Bà Đen mountain, we were amazed at its _____ scenery.	**MIND**
39.	The rescue of the trapped miners quickly became a _____ event that captured international media attention.	**NEWS**
40.	The increasing number of people visiting museums is _____ a sign of the public's growing interest in history.	**APPEAR**

Your answers:

31.	**32.**	**33.**	**34.**	**35.**
36.	**37.**	**38.**	**39.**	**40.**

SECTION C: READING (60 points)

PART 1. For questions 1-10, read the following passage and choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D. Write your answers in the numbered spaces provided.

Over the past few years, the advent of technology has exerted profound impacts on the world of work. It has not only given rise to a number of promising professions but also changed the manner in which people complete their jobs. In particular, rather than receiving employment in a single company, individuals can self-regulate their work and provide services to more than one customer. This so-called freelancing approach will be discussed in the following sections.

(**I**) Freelancing has emerged as a popular career choice as it allows individuals to **take the reins of** their professional journeys while balancing personal aspirations. (**II**) For many, it serves as an escape from the rigidity of the conventional 9-to-5 routine, granting them the autonomy to define their work-life balance and explore their potential on their own terms. (**III**) The flexibility associated with freelancing is perhaps its most attractive feature. (**IV**) Freelancers can work from virtually anywhere, whether it's the comfort of their home, a bustling café, or even a serene beach. They also have the liberty to select clients and projects that align with their interests and professional goals. In recent years, freelancing has become much more accessible thanks to the rise of remote work and online platforms. Typical websites such as Upwork, Fiverr, and Toptal connect freelancers with clients all over the world, creating diverse opportunities in fields ranging from graphic design to software development.

Tempting though such freedom and approachability sound, freelancing still comes with a few challenges. First of all, freelancers may take responsibility for juggling multiple roles, such as acting as their own accountant, project manager, and customer service representative. In other words, they manage their own finances, negotiate contracts, and market **their** skills effectively to attract clients. Second, the lack of a steady paycheck and job satisfaction can be **daunting**, particularly during the initial stages when building a reputation and client base requires considerable effort. To be more specific, income is often irregular, with periods of abundance followed by dry spells. The absence of traditional employment benefits, like health insurance or paid leave, also demands careful financial planning and self-discipline. Nevertheless, for those who thrive on creativity, adaptability, and independence, freelancing can be an immensely satisfying career path, offering both professional fulfillment and personal growth.

All things considered, it is reasonable why many suppose that the risks of freelancing are outweighed by the rewards. **While freelancing requires endurance and adaptability, it offers unmatched freedom to build a career tailored to individual strengths and passions**. New graduates should consider this flexible, fulfilling, and self-directed professional option instead of following the footsteps of previous generations, choosing more traditional jobs.

1. Where in paragraph 2 does the following sentence best fit?

This form of self-employment enables people to choose their projects, set flexible schedules, and work independently.

A. (I) **B. (II)** **C. (III)** **D. (IV)**

2. The phrase "**take the reins of**" in paragraph 2 could best be replaced by _____.

A. take advantage of **B.** take account of **C.** take control of **D.** take care of

3. The word "**daunting**" in paragraph 3 is **OPPOSITE** in meaning to _____.

A. stressful **B.** encouraging **C.** thoughtful **D.** terrifying

4. The word "**their**" in paragraph 3 refers to _____.

A. finances' **B.** freelancers' **C.** clients' **D.** contracts'

5. Which of the following is **NOT TRUE** according to the passage?

A. Freelancers are guaranteed a stable income and secure job opportunities.

15. As his eyesight began to _____, he spent a lot of time writing about it – both poems and 'eye journals' - describing what he saw as he looked out through damaged eyes.

A. recover **B.** penetrate **C.** deteriorate **D.** sharpen

16. Some consequences of global warming are already obvious, _____ is extreme weather.

A. one which **B.** one of which **C.** which one **D.** which one of

For questions 17-18, choose the letter A, B, C, or D to indicate the word / phrase that is CLOSEST in meaning to the underlined part. Write your answers in the numbered spaces provided.

17. The journalist was known to **embellish** her stories with dramatic details that had little basis in fact.

A. withhold **B.** conceal **C.** exaggerate **D.** fabricate

18. Many businesses employ livestreaming in their product promotion as it is **two a penny** these days.

A. very common **B.** very reliable **C.** very inexpensive **D.** very efficient

For questions 19-20, choose the letter A, B, C, or D to indicate the word / phrase that is OPPOSITE in meaning to the underlined part. Write your answers in the numbered spaces provided.

19. They have been forced to live in **marginal** environments, such as deserts and arctic wastelands.

A. suburban **B.** forgotten **C.** abandoned **D.** favorable

20. My grandparents frequently go for a run to **work up** their appetite.

A. suppress **B.** develop **C.** satisfy **D.** arouse

Your answers:

1.	**2.**	**3.**	**4.**	**5.**	**6.**	**7.**	**8.**	**9.**	**10.**
11.	**12.**	**13.**	**14.**	**15.**	**16.**	**17.**	**18.**	**19.**	**20.**

PART 2. For questions 21-30, identify ten errors in the following passage and correct them. Write your answers in the numbered spaces provided.

Line	
1	Based on the true story of how mathematician Alan Turing has cracked a secret code and helped alter the course of
2	the Second World War, The Imitation Game proves that reality can sometimes be even more compelling then fiction.
3	Moving between different stages of Turing's life, the film portrays the struggles of a misunderstood genius and is
4	widely regarded as one of the fine biopics of recent years.
5	Benedict Cumberbatch stars as Turing, who is recruited by the British government deciphering the Enigma code
6	machine. Turing appears arrogantly, antisocial and difficult to understand, largely because his extraordinary intellect
7	puts him apart from the rest of the team. Only Joan Clarke, played by Keira Knightley, succeeds in establishing a
8	genuine connection with him. Despite their differences, the group eventually manages to break the code.
9	Nevertheless the events surrounding Enigma are already familiar to many viewers, the film stays remarkably
10	engaging as the story gradually unfolds. Through many expected twists and turns, Cumberbatch delivers a
11	outstanding performance as the flawed yet brilliant mathematician. If you appreciate thought-provoked historical
12	dramas rather than action-packed blockbusters, this film is certainly worth watching.

Your answers:

Question	Line	Error	Correction	Question	Line	Error	Correction
21.				**26.**			
22.				**27**			
23.				**28.**			
24.				**29.**			
25.				**30.**			

PART 3. For questions 31-40, use the word given in capitals to form a word that best completes each sentence. Write your answers in the numbered spaces provided.

31. It's unkind to _____ someone else's achievement just to make yourself feel more important. **LITTLE**

32. Some phones can recognise the user's voice and be _____ by it. **ACT**

33. Janet had to _____ from the volleyball team because of severe injury. **DRAW**

34. Anna started using an _____ cream to keep her skin looking healthy. **AGE**

35. You can ask a _____ for advice on what kind of food you should eat to keep you healthy. **DIET**

B. It allows many individuals to avoid the rigidity of the 9-to-5 work routine.

C. Freelancers must manage their professional responsibilities on their own.

D. Freelancers can determine appropriate clients based on their preferences.

6. Which of the following best summarizes paragraph 3?

A. Freelancing presents plenty of problems such as irregular income and lack of benefits but the need for self-management can be highly satisfying for those who value creativity and independence.

B. Freelancers may not thrive due to income unpredictability, heavy burden and absence of employment benefits so they need to develop a careful financial plan and maintain self-discipline.

C. Despite the unpredictability of freelancing, it provides not only professional fulfillment but also personal growth to for those who thrive on creativity, adaptability, and independence.

D. Freelancers face difficulties like irregular income, multiple roles, and insufficient benefits, but they can easily overcome these challenges because of the flexible nature of their work.

7. Which of the following best paraphrases the underlined sentence in paragraph 4?

A. With the help of online platforms, freelancing brings about considerable freedom to pursue a career suitable for individual ambitions.

B. Freelancing demands perseverance and flexibility but allows individuals to design careers that align with their unique skills and interests.

C. Freelancing eliminates the need for hard work while ensuring success in a chosen career path tailored to individual strengths and passions.

D. Although freelancing requires endurance and adaptability, it creates various opportunities in areas like graphic design and software development.

8. Which of the following is **TRUE** according to the passage?

A. Upwork, Fiverr, and Toptal facilitate interaction between freelancers and global clients.

B. Establishing close relationships with a large number of clients is essential to freelancers.

C. Freelancing is a low-risk career offering immediate high income with minimal effort.

D. A great deal of people believe that the drawbacks of freelancing outweigh its benefits.

9. Which word best describes the author's attitude towards freelancing in the passage?

A. carefree **B.** supportive **C.** dismissive **D.** reluctant

10. The reading passage can be followed by a paragraph focusing on _____.

A. how to handle multiple clients as a freelancer

B. how to pick out the appropriate freelancer

C. how to increase the income of a freelancer

D. how to begin the journey of a freelancer

Your answers:

1.	2.	3.	4.	5.	6.	7.	8.	9.	10.

PART 2. For questions 11-23, read the following passage and complete the tasks given. Write your answers in the numbered spaces provided.

SUNSET FOR THE OIL BUSINESS

Members of the Department Analysis Centre (ODAC) presented technical data supporting their grim forecast that the world oil is perilously running out. ODAC leading experts, including the geologist Colin Campbell, rejected contradictory views from America's Geological Survey and the International Energy Agency. Dr Campbell even decried the display of ignorance, denial and obfuscation by government, industry and academics on this topic.

So is the oil really running out? Obviously yes. Nobody seriously disputes the notion that oil is a non-renewable resource that will run out someday, be that years or decades away. The harder question is determining when oil will get scarce. Answering that question involves scaling Hubbert's peak.

M. King Hubbert, a Shell geologist of legendary status among depletion experts, forecast in 1956 that American oil production would peak in the early 1970s and then decline, in something resembling a bell-shaped curve. At the time, his forecast was rubbished. After 1970, however, empirical evidence proved him correct: oil production in America did indeed peak and has been in decline ever since. Dr Hubbert's analysis drew on the observation that oil production in a new area typically rises quickly at first, as the easiest and cheapest reserves are tapped. Over time, reservoirs age and go into decline, and so lifting oil becomes more expensive. Oil from that area then becomes less competitive than other fuels, or oil from other areas. Consequently,

production slows down and usually declines.

His successful prediction has emboldened new geologists to apply his methodology on a global scale. Chief among them are the experts at ODAC, who worry about global peak in production in the next decade. Dr Campbell used to argue that the peak should have come already; he now thinks it is just around the corner. A heavyweight has now joined this gloomy chorus. Kenneth Deffeyes of Princeton University argues in a lively new book that global oil production could peak as soon as 2004. That sharply contradicts mainstream thinking. America's Geological Survey prepared an exhaustive study of oil depletion last year (in part to rebut Dr Campbell's arguments) that put the peak of production some decades off. The IEA has just foreseen enough oil to comfortably meet the demand to 2020 from remaining reserves. René Dahan, a top manager of the world's largest energy company, insists that the world will be awash in oil for another 70 years.

Who is right? In making sense of these wildly opposing views, it is useful to look back at the pitiful history of oil forecasting. Doomsters have been predicting dry wells since the 1970s, but so far the oil is still gushing. Nearly all the predictions for 2000 made after the 1970s oil shocks were far too pessimistic. Michael Lynch, an economic consultancy, is one of the few oil forecasters who has got things right. In a new paper, Dr Lynch analyses those historical forecasts. He finds evidence of both bias and recurring errors, which suggests that methodological mistakes were the problem. In particular, he faults forecasters who used Hubbert-style analysis for relying on fixed estimates of how much "ultimately recoverable" oil there really is below ground, in the industry's jargon: that figure is actually a dynamic one, as improvements in infrastructure, knowledge and technology raise the amount of oil which is recoverable.

That points to technological innovation, which will probably determine whether the pessimists or the optimists are right. The former tends to be dismissive of claims of forthcoming technological revolutions in areas like deep-water drilling and enhanced recovery. Dr Deffeyes captures this end-of-technology mindset well. In his opinion, the industry has already spent billions inventing most of the wheels so it is difficult today to ask for new technology. Yet techno-optimists argue that the technological revolution in oil has only just begun. Average recovery rates (how much of the known oil in a reservoir can actually be brought to the surface) are still only around 30-35%. Industry optimists believe that newly crafted techniques today could lift that figure to 50-60% within a decade. Given the industry's astonishing track record of innovation, it may be foolish to bet against it. That is the result of adversity: the nationalisations of the 1970s forced Big Oil to develop reserves in expensive and inaccessible places, undermining Dr Hubbert's assumption that cheap reserves are developed first. The resulting upstream investments have driven down the cost of finding and developing wells over the last two decades from over $20 to around $6 a barrel. The cost of producing oil has fallen by half, to under $4 a barrel.

Such miracles will not come cheap, however, since much of the world's oil is now produced in rapidly declining fields. The IEA concludes that global oil production need not peak in the next two decades if necessary investments are made. So how much is necessary? The agency reckons they must invest $1 trillion in non-OPEC countries over the next decade alone. That's quite a figure.

Questions 11-15: Do the following statements agree with the information given in the reading passage?

Write **YES** if the statement agrees with the writer's claims
NO if the statement contradicts the writer's claims
NOT GIVEN if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

11. Oil is likely to last longer than most other non-renewable energy sources.
12. Hubbert has a high-profile reputation amongst ODAC members.
13. The majority of geologists believe that global oil production will peak within this decade.
14. More than half of the oil known to exist in the ground is currently being successfully extracted.
15. History has shown that some of Hubbert's principles were mistaken.

Questions 16-18: Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

16. Hubbert witnessed that in any new oil-producing area, output goes up sharply at first because the _____ reserves are utilized before others.
17. Lynch's analysis of past oil predictions revealed bias as well as _____, suggesting that the problem lay with the methods used.
18. The IEA declares that a global peak in oil production over the next 20 years is avoidable, provided that oil companies make _____.

Questions 19-23: Look at the following statements (questions 19-23) and the list of people below. Match each statement with the correct person, A-E. Write the correct letter, A-E.

NB You may use any letter more than once.

19. _____ has found fault in the geological research procedure used to forecast oil production.
20. _____ has provided the longest-range prediction regarding oil supply.
21. _____ has convinced others that oil production will follow a particular model.
22. _____ has accused fellow scientists of deliberately ignoring evidence about oil depletion.
23. _____ has questioned whether significant advances in oil extraction technology are achievable.

List of People

A. Colin Campell	**B.** M. King Hubbert	**C.** Kenneth Deffeyes	**D.** René Dahan	**E.** Michael Lynch

Your answers:

11.	**12.**	**13.**	**14.**	**15.**	**16.**	**17.**
18.	**19.**	**20.**	**21.**	**22.**	**23.**	

PART 3. For questions 24-33, read the following passage and fill in each blank with ONE WORD. Write your answers in the numbered spaces provided.

While citizens of developed nations can easily visit a doctor or a hospital for a medical check, those in some **(24)**_____ countries are not so lucky. However, a satellite phone, a computer and some simple technology could establish a direct link **(25)**_____ them and hospital specialists globally.

Telemedicine, the practice of medicine at a **(26)**_____, began with the telephone. Today, it utilizes video technology and high-speed satellite communications.

Telemedicine enables doctors to examine patients across continents and **(27)**_____ in extreme environments like Antarctica, potentially saving lives when evacuation is impossible. Such technology promises to revolutionize everyday healthcare **(28)**_____ reducing hospital queues, minimizing patient travel for follow-up appointments, **(29)**_____ enhancing care for the elderly through 'video visits' for immediate assistance. Soon, 'video-conferencing calls' with doctors for faraway examinations will **(30)**_____ commonplace. Furthermore, telemedicine is transforming medical education, **(31)**_____ allows students worldwide to learn from leading experts through live, interactive sessions, surpassing traditional textbooks.

The application of telemedicine extends to **(32)**_____ locations like ships and offshore installations, providing crucial medical support in emergencies, such as diagnosing an oil-rig worker's head injury via video link **(33)**_____ stormy weather prevented transport to the mainland.

Your answers:

24.	**25.**	**26.**	**27.**	**28.**
29.	**30.**	**31.**	**32.**	**33.**

PART 4. For questions 34-40, read the following passage about the weather. Seven sentences have been removeD. Choose from the sentences A-H the one which fits each gap. There is one extra sentence which you do not need to use. Write your answers in the numbered spaces provided.

THE WEATHER

Weather plays an integral part in our daily lives. **(34)**_____. No doubt those same primitive people stood in front of their dwellings a few hours later to admire a rainbow or gaze at a spectacular cloud on the horizon.

What has changed over the centuries is how people interpret the weather. Most of us no longer worry, as our ancestors did, about trying to please the spirits who sent the weather to punish or reward us. Today, when the weather doesn't do what we want, we tend to look for a more scientific explanation. **(35)**_____. These things have passed into the popular vocabulary.

There is still a lot we don't understand about weather. We can now predict some aspects of cold climates a whole year in advance, and yet nobody can tell you if a thunderstorm will strike at precisely 4pm tomorrow. We understand the basic physical laws that drive our atmosphere, but we can't fully observe every detail of the current weather. There is also another factor restraining our understanding. **(36)**_____. The weather defies computer predictions and seems to behave with a mind of its own.

Where does that leave you, the consumer of weather information? **(37)**_____. But as the wise people of the information revolution keep reminding us, data isn't the same thing as information. You might be searching for a very specific forecast, say to plan a wedding. Maybe you are heading into the countryside for a few days and want to know the weather signs that could mean trouble. Or perhaps you are travelling to a city halfway across the world and you need a sense of the typical weather at your destination.

The Rough Guide to Weather aims to help you get the weather knowledge you are seeking. **(38)**_____. We also take you behind the scenes of the government forecasting centres, the TV studios and other places where your daily weather broadcast

is put together.

For all the gains the forecasting has made with the help of computer guidance, humans have not yet been completely removed from the process. **(39)**_____. You will learn how the experts decide what to tell you about the upcoming weather and what they may choose to withhold due to limits of time and space, their own uncertainty, politics and other factors.

In the end, weather is what the public choose to make of it. **(40)**_____. It is hoped that this book makes the weather you experience as enjoyable, understandable and as memorable as possible.

Missing sentences:

A. However, the speed of computers that project weather far into the future is increasing

B. Particularly when the weather turns threatening, skilled forecasters can go a step beyond computer guidance and save lives in the process

C. Descriptions and statistics of the weather in dozens of countries and over two hundred destinations around the world have been collected in it

D. It's the fault of the jet stream, a low-pressure centre or global warming

E. Even though much is known about the individual parts of our atmosphere, the interplay between them can produce what scientists call "non-linear behavior"

F. Every weather forecast we see or hear passes through the filter of our own likes, dislikes, hopes and fears

G. These days, hundreds of maps and forecasts can be found on the internet and on TV

H. Since the earliest times when humans scurried into their caves to avoid a storm, people have been fascinated by the weather

Your answers:

34.	35.	36.	37.	38.	39.	40.

SECTION D: WRITING (50 points)

PART 1. For questions 1-10, complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first one, using the words given. Do not change the words given. Write your answers in the numbered spaces provided.

1. Studying a second language both improves cognitive flexibility and opens doors to understanding diverse educational systems.

→ Not only _____ opens doors to understanding diverse educational systems.

2. It is advised that the female employee return home by 11 o'clock at the latest.

→ If I were _____ than 11 o'clock.

3. You don't have to finish the presentation outline before Saturday.

→ You are _____ the presentation outline before Saturday.

4. So smart were the coach's tactics that Vietnam's national football team achieved a great success in the last Sea Games.

→ It was _____ Vietnam's national football team to the victory in the last Sea Games.

5. Most modern companies want to employ people with good intercultural communication skills.

→ Most modern companies insist _____ employed.

6. If they catch anyone dropping litter in Singapore, they immediately make them pay a fine. (**SPOT**)

→ Anyone caught _____ in Singapore.

7. The investors were so pessimistic about what happened. (**VIEWED**)

→ The investors should _____ positive light.

8. I don't know why Fred made such an extraordinary decision. (**PROMPTED**)

→ I don't know _____ a decision.

9. My close friend changed the meaning of what I said and I was quite upset about it. (**CONTEXT**)

→ My close friend _____ and I was quite upset about it.

10. Minh let nothing stand in his way of becoming a politician. (**OBSTACLES**)

→ Minh _____ to become a politician.

PART 2. Write an essay about the following topic:

Some people think that the government should provide people with free healthcare. Others, however, believe that people should pay for their own healthcare. Discuss both views and give your own opinion.

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge and experience. Write at least **250** words.